

MININDU MALLAWA NANAYAKKARALAGE GEDARA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Geology PhD student with graduate research and field experience in sedimentology, stratigraphy, geochemistry, hydrogeology, core logging, petrography, and experimental sedimentology. Hands-on experience with flume simulations, SEM-EDS, Raman spectroscopy, XRD, cathodoluminescence, 2D resistivity surveying, ArcGIS Pro, and geochemical modeling. Seeking a geology/geoscience internship in the oil and gas industry where subsurface interpretation, field and laboratory data, and quantitative analysis can support exploration and reservoir-focused workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Geoscience: Sedimentology, stratigraphy, core logging, petrography, field mapping, hydrogeology, groundwater exploration, geohazard mapping, laboratory sampling, chemical analysis
- Laboratory & Analytical: SEM-EDS, Raman spectroscopy, XRD, cathodoluminescence, ion milling, flume simulations, geochemical modeling
- Geophysical & Field Methods: 2D resistivity surveying, groundwater drilling support, geological fieldwork, core/sample documentation
- Software & Data: ArcGIS Pro, Geochemist's Workbench, Petroledge, MATLAB, Python (intermediate), Microsoft Excel, Microsoft Word

EDUCATION

PhD in Geology <i>Indiana University Bloomington</i> , Bloomington, IN	Aug 2024–Present
• GPA: 3.77/4.00 Advisor: Prof. Juergen Schieber	
MS in Geology <i>Kansas State University</i> , Manhattan, KS	Aug 2022–May 2024
• GPA: 3.67/4.00 Advisor: Dr. Karin Goldberg-Miller	
BS (Honors) in Geology <i>University of Peradeniya</i> , Kandy, Sri Lanka	Jan 2017–Jul 2021
• GPA: 3.76/4.00 Advisor: Prof. Atula Senaratne	

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Intern <i>National Water Supply and Drainage Board</i> , Anuradhapura, Sri Lanka	2019
• Conducted 2D resistivity surveys and supported groundwater exploration and drilling activities.	
• Performed core logging and assisted with hydrogeological data analysis, interpretation, and technical reporting.	
Intern <i>National Building and Research Organisation</i> , Kegalle, Sri Lanka	2020
• Supported geohazard-zone mapping and field-based assessments used in relocation and risk-mitigation programs.	
• Contributed geological observations and mapped data to technical reports for geohazard mitigation.	
Associate Instructor <i>Indiana University</i> , Bloomington, IN	2024–Present
• Support undergraduate geology coursework through laboratory guidance, grading, and technical instruction.	
Teaching Assistant <i>Kansas State University</i> , Manhattan, KS	2022–2024
• Led undergraduate geology laboratory sessions, evaluated technical work, and mentored students in applied geoscience concepts.	
Teaching Assistant <i>University of Peradeniya</i> , Kandy, Sri Lanka	2021–2022
• Led geology laboratory sessions and supported fieldwork organization, instruction, and assessment.	

SELECTED RESEARCH, PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

- Graduate research: Origin and paragenetic relations of chert nodules/horizons in the Permian Florence Limestone, Flint Hills, Kansas; presented at GSA Connects 2023 and Kansas State University Research and State Conference 2024.
- Project involvement: Seismic Investigation, Victoria Dam & Reservoir, Mahaweli Authority, Sri Lanka (2021); Thalpitigala Multipurpose Reservoir Scheme, Department of Irrigation, Sri Lanka (2019).
- Goldberg-Miller, K., & Mallawa, M. (2025). "Origin of Chert Horizons in the Permian Florence Limestone, Flint Hills, Kansas." Under review, *Journal of South American Geosciences*.
- Sajeevan, T., et al. (2023). "Towards a More Efficient In and Ex Situ Conservation of Sri Lankan Wild Rice Species." *Plants*, 12(11), 2149.

AWARDS & LEADERSHIP

Grassman Fellowship in Clay Mineralogy (2024) | David C. Underwood Scholarship (2023) | Graduate Student Research Grant, Kansas Geological Foundation (2023) | Mudge-Thompson Scholarship (2022) | University Award for Academic Excellence (2021) | Organizing Committee, Crossroads 2025 Geologic Conference | Treasurer, Sri Lankan Students' Association at Kansas State University (2023–2024) | Member, Williston Geological Club (2022–2024)